



Practice spontaneous problems for Odyssey Inclusive Coaches - 2024

Coaches, please use the problems provided below to practice spontaneous with your teams before your first tournament. Depending on how often you meet, doing a spontaneous practice problem at each practice session (or once per week) is a good way to get them ready and to build teamwork and other skills.

The type of spontaneous problem it is (**hands on**, **verbal**, or **verbal/hands on**) is indicated at the top of each problem's directions and highlighted. As with the Long Term problem, there are **three options** for coaches to choose from for each

spontaneous problem, based on the abilities of their team members. As these are practice problems, the options can be accommodated by the coach, as needed. Please share any additional accommodations you felt were necessary to the program director so she can incorporate them into future versions of the problems. Feel free to alter the language of the problems as you see fit.

Any materials needed for the spontaneous problems are hopefully items you have available in your classrooms or are easily attainable.

At the tournament, teams will be given a maximum of 12-15 minutes to solve their spontaneous problem. When you first start practicing spontaneous with your teams, this time can be increased, but not excessively. Try to get the team used to solving the problem within 12-15 minutes by tournament time.

Spontaneous problems can be repeated with the same or different materials/prompts (or trying the different options in each problem) to give the team multiple opportunities to solve the problem in new ways.

Be sure to have all the necessary materials ready to go before beginning that spontaneous problem practice with your team.

There is a page break between each problem so you can print them out separately.

Reminder: If assistance is provided to the team during spontaneous, keep the 80/20 rule in mind. Approximately 80% of the work should be done by the students on the team with 20% support from the coach or another adult.

The first practice spontaneous problem begins on the next page. 8-) Be sure to email the Odyssey Inclusive director, Lynn Larsen, at odysseyinclusive@odysseyofthemind.com if you have any questions!

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Practice Spontaneous #1: Hands on - Stacking Towers

Problem overview: In this problem, teams will be asked to create stacked towers.

Option 1

Materials given: Wooden building blocks that can be stacked (as many as you think the team can stack).

Time allowed: Teams may work until all the blocks have been used, but try not to go past 15 minutes.

Directions to the team: Please listen to these directions carefully. You must work together as a team to make buildings/towers out of these blocks that are at least two blocks high using as many blocks as possible. Team members can work with one other person, small groups, or alone. Be sure to share the blocks using good teamwork.

Team feedback: Your team will be given feedback about your buildings and how you worked together as a team. If appropriate, team members can share how/why they stacked their blocks.

Option 2

Materials given: A stack of 20 index cards - white or colored index cards are fine.

Time allowed: Teams may work until all index cards have been folded/stacked but try not to exceed 15 minutes.

Directions to the team: Please listen carefully to the directions. Your team must work together to find as many ways that the index cards can be folded so they will stand on their own (show an example where you fold the card in half and stand it on end horizontally and then vertically). There will be a bonus if your team can get the index cards to stand on top of each other. Team members can work in twos, small groups, or alone. Be sure to share the index cards using good teamwork.

Team feedback: Your team will be given feedback about the different ways that the index cards are standing and/or stacked and how you worked together as a team.

Option 3

Materials given: a stack of 20 index cards. White or colored index cards are fine.

Time allowed: Teams may work until all index cards have been folded/stacked but try not to exceed 15 minutes

Directions to the team:

There are two parts to this problem. Please listen to all of the directions carefully. 2

PART 1: Using only the materials given, you will be given 5-7 minutes to fold index cards in as many ways as you can think of. All of the folded cards must not be flat and must be at least 1 inch in height. Try to fold the index cards in different ways.

PART 2: Your team will stack the folded cards you have made (demonstrate if necessary showing cards folded vertically and horizontally) to make buildings. You may not use any materials to attach the cards to one another. They must stack on top of each other. How tall your buildings are will be measured at the end of the 5 minutes in Part 2.

When you are scored, you may not be touching any of your buildings. The buildings must stand alone for at least 5 seconds after you have finished making them in order to be scored.

Team feedback: You will be provided feedback on the height of your buildings, the construction of the individual buildings, and how you worked together as a team.

Option 1

Materials given to each student: A piece of paper with various shapes on it that are large enough to be colored in (e.g., circle, square, triangle, rectangle). Crayons/markers of different colors. There is a sample of this sheet you can use on page 5.

Time allowed: Teams are given approximately 10 minutes to finish.

Directions to the team: Please listen to these directions carefully. On the table you each have a piece of paper with different shapes on it. You are to fill in each shape with a different color. Pick one color, fill in a shape, then trade colors with someone else.

Team feedback: Your team will be given feedback about your shape coloring.

Option 2

Materials given to each student: A piece of paper with various shapes on it that are large enough to be colored in and drawn on (e.g., circle, square, triangle, rectangle), markers, crayons, pens. There is a sample you can use on page 5.

Time allowed: Teams are given approximately 10 minutes to finish.

Directions to the team: Please listen carefully to the directions. Your job is to create something out of each shape on your paper. For example, I could make the square into a house. Try to think of unusual things you could make your shapes into.

(Team members can share what they drew when time is up.)

Team feedback: Your team will be given feedback about their different things they created.

Option 3 - Verbal/Hands-on

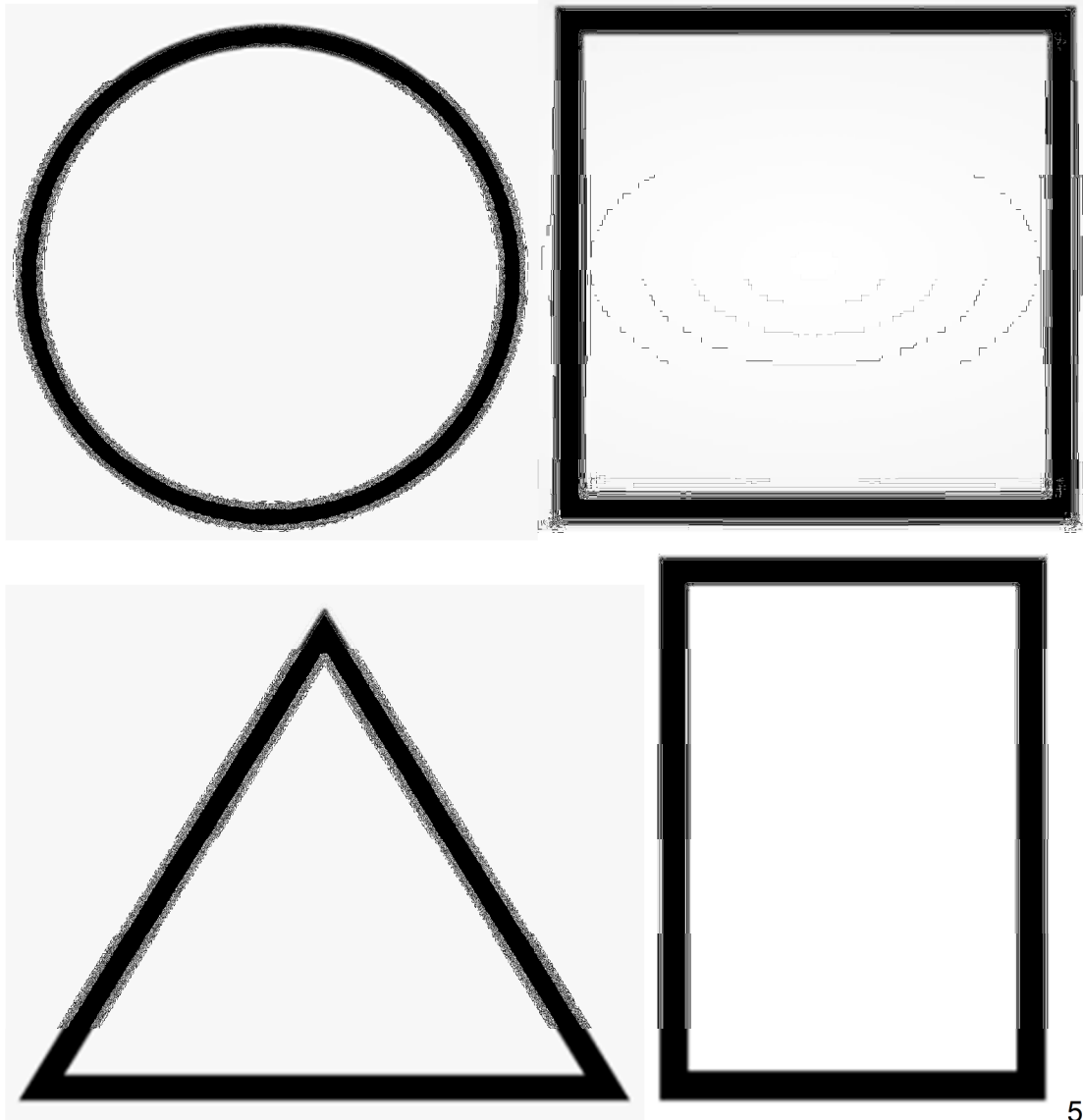
Materials given to each student: A piece of paper with various shapes on it that are large enough to be colored in and drawn on (e.g., circle, square, triangle, rectangle), markers, crayons, pens. There is a sample of this sheet you can use on page 5.

Time allowed: Teams are given approximately 10 minutes to finish.

Directions to the team: Please listen carefully to the directions. Your job is to create something with each of the shapes and tell a short story (one sentence per shape) using those items. You do not have to use your shapes in the order they are on the page.

(Once team members have had a chance to create their shapes) Let's start with (name). Remember to tell us a story with one sentence per shape about your drawings.

Team feedback: You will be provided feedback on your responses about your shape



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Practice Spontaneous #3: Verbal - Circle Around!

Problem overview: In this problem, teams will be asked to work with things that are round.

Option 1

Materials given: Pictures of items in different shapes or actual items in different shapes (e.g., triangles, squares, circles, rectangles). Try to provide at least 3 items per team member.

Time allowed: Teams are given approximately 10 minutes to respond, depending on the number of items available.

Directions to the team: Please listen to these directions carefully. Here are some things (or pictures of items) that are different shapes. I want each of you to pick out an item that is a circle or is round when I let you know it is your turn. (Point to each team member or say their name to indicate it is their turn to pick out a round object or a circle. Continue with the other shapes.)

Team feedback: Your team will be given feedback about your answers.

Option 2

Materials given: A piece of paper and something to write with. Answers may be dictated to an adult.

Time allowed: Team members take turns responding for 3-4 turns each.

Directions to the team: Please listen carefully to the directions. When it is your turn, I want you to name something that is round then use that item in a sentence. For example, if it was my turn, I would say an Orange. My sentence would be, “An orange is my favorite fruit for a snack.” We are going to start with (name) and each team member will have 3-4 turns to answer. Let’s take a minute or two to each write down 3-4 things that are round on the piece of paper in front of you. Try to come up with answers different from your teammates. If you want to talk to your teammates, that is fine.

Once team members have had a chance to write down their answers say, “let’s start with (name). Remember to state what your round object is and then use that word in a sentence.

Team feedback: Your team will be given feedback about their different round objects and sentences.

Option 3

Materials given: Piece of paper and something to write with. Responses can be dictated to an adult.

Time allowed: Team members are each allowed 3-4 responses each.

Directions to the team: Please listen carefully to the directions. When it is your turn, I want you to name something that is round or that is a circle then use that item creatively in a sentence. For

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example, if it was my turn, I would say eyeglasses can be circles. Harry Potter’s eye glasses are circles. We are going to start with (name) and each team member will have 3-4 turns to answer.

Let’s take a minute or two to each write down 3-4 things that are round or that are a circle on the piece of paper in front of you and think about how to use it creatively in a sentence. Try to come up with answers different from your teammates. If you want to talk to your teammates during thinking time, that’s fine.

Once team members have had a chance to write down their answers say, “let’s start with (name). Remember to state what your round or circle object is and then use that word creatively in a sentence.”

Team feedback: You will be provided feedback on your responses about things that are round. 7

Practice Spontaneous #4: Hands on - Flip Flop

Problem overview: In this problem, teams will be asked to flip various items over.

Option 1

Materials given: Wooden building blocks that can be turned over (as many as you think the team can turn over). These can be the same building blocks used for stacking structures problem. Mark one side of each block with a piece of colored tape.

Time allowed: Teams may work until all the blocks have been flipped, but try not to go past 15 minutes.

Directions to the team: Please listen to these directions carefully. You must work together as a team to turn these blocks over. Team members can work in twos, small groups, or alone. Be sure to share the blocks using good teamwork.

Team feedback: Your team will be given feedback about how you turned the blocks over and how you worked together as a team.

Option 2

Materials given: 2-3 spatulas and items that can be flipped over safely with them such as erasers, cards, blocks, small stuffed animals, etc.

Time allowed: Teams may work until all the items have been flipped, but try not to go past 15 minutes. This problem can be altered to add two taped circles on the table that the team has to get the objects into.

Directions to the team: Please listen carefully to the directions. On the table are some objects and spatulas (show items to the team). You must work together as a team to give everyone a chance to flip something over using a spatula. The items must be flipped carefully and cannot be flipped high in the air or land off the table. (If time allows they can flip the objects back over.)

Team feedback: Your team will be given feedback about how they worked together to flip the objects.

Option 3

Materials given: 5-7 large washers (or something similar) with the numbers 1-7 written on them, 2 drinking straws, 12 inches of string, 1 small paper cup, scissors, scotch tape, 2 pipe cleaners, or any other materials you feel are appropriate that are available.

Problem set up: On a table, tape off 5-7 circles that the teams will flip the washers into, leaving enough room for the team to flip a washer into a circle. You can also tape circles of colored construction paper onto the table. Place one washer outside of each circle. You can decide how far the washer should be from the circle - possibly increasing the distance each time you practice the problem.

Time allowed: Try to keep the time to no longer than 15 minutes.

Directions to the team:

There are two parts to this problem. Please listen to all of the directions carefully.

PART 1: Please listen carefully to the directions. On the table are 5 (or 6 or 7) circles. You will be given these washers (show them) and these materials (show). Your goal as a team is to develop a way or different ways to flip a washer into each of the circles. You cannot place the washers in the circles with your own hands or touch the washers with your hands. You may try out your flipping methods any time during part 1. During part 2, you will be timed for a score.

PART 2: One washer will be placed on the table with the number facing up outside of each circle. The goal is to use the items your team made to flip a washer into each circle, so that the number doesn't show and is inside a circle. There can only be one washer per circle and you will be given no more than 10 minutes to get the washers in the circles. If you flip a washer and it does not land inside a circle, the coach can move the washer back to the starting spot.

Team feedback: You will be provided feedback on what you built to flip the washers, how many washers ended up in circles, and how you worked together as a team. There is a bonus if all circles have a washer inside at the end of time!

Problem overview: In this problem, teams will be asked to share their favorite songs.

Option 1

Materials given: A list with some of the team's favorite songs and songs they do not like. Or, you can put together a playlist of songs on a device.

Time allowed: Teams are given approximately 10 minutes to respond, depending on the number of responses given.

Directions to the team: Please listen to these directions carefully. Your teacher wants to put together a playlist of the team's favorite songs. I'm going to read the names of some songs (or play parts of songs on a device) and each team member will let me know if they like the song or they don't like the song. (give them an appropriate way to indicate this based on their abilities. Point to each team member or say their name to indicate it is their turn to indicate they like or don't like a song.)

Team feedback: Your team will be given feedback about your answers.

Option 2

Materials given: A piece of paper and something to write with. Answers may be dictated to an adult.

Time allowed: Team members take turns responding for 3-4 turns each.

Directions to the team: Please listen carefully to the directions. When it is your turn, I want you to name a song you like and one you don't like. Let's take a minute or two to each write down 3-4 songs we like and don't like on the piece of paper in front of you. Try to come up with answers different from your teammates.

(Once team members have had a chance to write down their answers say) Let's start with (name). Remember to state what song you like and what song you don't like.

Team feedback: Your team will be given feedback about their answers.

Option 3

Materials given: Piece of paper and something to write with. Responses can be dictated to an adult.

Time allowed: Team members are each allowed 3-4 responses each.

Directions to the team: Please listen carefully to the directions. When it is your turn, I want you to name a song then change one word in the title of the song to make it a creative and fun song title. For example, if it was my turn, I would say Shake it Off could be Bake it Off!

(Once team members have had a chance to write down their answers say) Let's start with (name). Remember to give the name of the song then change one word to make it creative and fun.

Team feedback: You will be provided feedback on your responses about the creative song titles.